

Ali Demir

PhD Candidate in Economics

Applied Microeconomics | Migration, Family and Regional Economics

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RESEARCH PROFILE

PhD candidate in economics specializing in causal inference, migration, family economics, housing and regional inequality. My research uses German longitudinal survey data, regional data linkages and newly digitized historical regional statistics to study how migration and housing markets shape family formation, labour-market outcomes and transitions to adulthood. Methodologically, my work combines panel-data econometrics, instrumental variables, event-study designs, difference-in-differences logic, historical data construction and robustness-based identification.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics

2023–expected 2026

Ruhr University Bochum, Germany

- Dissertation: *Essays in Empirical Family and Regional Economics*.
- Supervisors: 1st Prof. Dr. Thomas K. Bauer / 2nd Prof. Dr. Arnaud Chevalier
- Affiliation: Chair of Empirical Economics / DFG funded RTG 2484

M.Sc. in Behavioral and Applied Economics

2021–2023

University of Trento, Italy

- Exchange year in Public Economics, Free University of Berlin, Germany.
- Research stay at Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria.

B.Sc. in Mathematics

2016–2021

Middle East Technical University, Turkey

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

PhD Researcher in Economics

2023–expected 2026

Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Conduct doctoral research on migration, family formation, housing and regional inequality, combining German microdata, historical regional statistics, causal-inference designs and original OCR-assisted data construction.

Research Intern

Jul 2022–Oct 2022

Vienna University of Economics and Business, Institute for Cognition and Behavior

- Designed and implemented an oTree-based bargaining experiment on overconfidence, prosociality and motivated beliefs, including experimental workflow, participant decision screens and data-generation structure; the project formed the empirical basis of my M.Sc. thesis.

Student Research Assistant

Jan 2022–Aug 2022

University of Trento, Department of Economics and Management

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor / Course Designer: Introductory Migration Economics

Winter Semester 2025/26

Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Designed an English-language bachelor level seminar with lecture material on migration definitions, migrant selection, Roy model intuition, integration and human capital, Chiswick–Borjas earnings assimilation, empirical designs and labour-market effects.

WORKING PAPERS AND RESEARCH PROJECTS

German Internal Migration: A Marriage Market Perspective. Job-market paper. Studies whether young, female-skewed East–West migration after German reunification affected divorce rates in receiving West German districts. The project constructs district-year measures of cumulative exposure to young East German migrants and relates this exposure to district-level divorce rates. To address endogenous migrant sorting, the paper uses a shift-share instrumental-variable strategy that combines pre-reunification East-linked settlement shares with a cumulative female-weighted East German labour-market push component. A major contribution is the construction of a new harmonized district-level panel of divorce, migration and population statistics from historical, partly non-machine-readable regional sources.

Housing Security and Family Expansion: Evidence from German Homeownership. Examines whether homeownership is associated with fertility outcomes among women in West Germany using SOEP-based longitudinal data. The preferred results provide limited evidence for effects on completed fertility, but indicate a positive and statistically meaningful effect on the transition to a second birth among women who already have one child.

Transition to Adulthood: Local Rents and Leaving the Parental Home. Studies whether local rental costs at the parental-home location predict young adults' first exit from the parental home in Germany. The main finding is cautious: once parental-home postal-code fixed effects and strong regional-year controls are included, there is no robust evidence that local rents explain first-exit timing or systematic spatial substitution across move types.

CONFERENCES

- “Housing and Fertility in Germany.” European Network for Housing Research (ENHR) Annual Conference 2025, *Affordable Housing in Greening Cities*, Grand Paris (Champs-sur-Marne), France, June 2025.

SKILLS

Software	Stata, R, Python, L ^A T _E X, oTree.
Languages	Turkish-Native, English-Fluent, German-B1, Italian-Elementary.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Editor behavioraleconomics.com, remote(UK)	<i>Jan 2022–Oct 2023</i>
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AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- University of Trento Merit Scholarship, 2021–2023.
- METU Alumni Association Merit Scholarship, 2016–2019.
- Honour Roll, Middle East Technical University, 2016–2017.
- Turkish Educational Foundation Merit Scholarship, 2013–2014.

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Thomas K. Bauer

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Prof. Dr. Susann Fiedler

Department of Strategy and Innovation, Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria

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Prof. Dr. Matteo Ploner

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